

Motor City Independent Shop Bulletin

Fall 2026 edition - regional parts and service trends for independent repair shops

This bulletin is circulated to independent shops across Metro Detroit. It carries seasonal demand notes and general trade commentary. It is informational only and carries no figures specific to any single shop.

Seasonal Demand Index

Category	Fall trend	Regional demand note
Batteries	Rising	Cold-weather testing season begins. Group sizes H6 and H7 move fastest through November.
Brakes	Rising	Pad and rotor jobs climb as roads slick over. Ceramic sets lead demand this quarter.
Wipers and fluids	Rising	Winter blend washer fluid and beam blades are strong counter add-ons through the season.
Air conditioning	Falling	Cooling work tapers off. Shift bay time toward heating and defrost complaints.
Tyres	Steady	Seasonal changeover keeps alignment racks busy across the region.

Training and Community

ASE refresher webinars continue every other Thursday evening. Shops running youth programmes are welcome to point students at the diagnostics track. Send restoration project photos to the regional spotlight desk for a feature.

Nothing in this bulletin requires action. It is provided as general trade reading.